

9.6

Checking understanding and summarizing

Worksheet

A These phrases are used for checking understanding. Complete the missing words.

- | | | |
|---|---|--|
| { | 1 | Sorry, can I _____ t? I'm afraid I don't understand. |
| | 2 | Sorry, could you explain in a little more d _____ l? |
| | 3 | I'm sorry, it's still not clear to me. What e _____ y do you mean _ _ 'a short delay'? |
| | 4 | Could you be a little more sp _____ c? |
| { | 5 | Are you s _ _ ing that ... ? |
| | 6 | So, in other words, Is that r _ _ _ t? |
| | 7 | So, if I understand c _ _ _ _ _ _ _ y, we can either ... or Is that right? |

- Can you see why the phrases have been put into two groups?

B Summarizing is a useful technique. Answer these questions.

1 Which of the following can 'summarizing' be used for?

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ checking understanding | ☐ keeping a positive atmosphere by reviewing progress |
| ☐ giving yourself time to think | ☐ finding a way out of a difficult situation |
| ☐ taking the initiative | ☐ preparing to close the negotiation |

2 Put these words in the correct order.

a Sorry, that can just again you over go?

b Can go I points through just those again?

c Can go far we we've over so what agreed?

d Let understand check just I me that

3 Which two-letter word is often used on its own for summarizing?

C Work with a partner and change roles when you finish.

Student A Choose a complicated topic that Student B knows nothing about. Talk about it for about five minutes. These phrases will help you:

Perhaps I didn't make myself clear. What I meant was ...

I'm sorry, that's not what I meant. If I can put it another way, ...

I'm afraid there's a slight misunderstanding. What I'm trying to say is ...

Student B Listen very carefully to Student A. When he/she finishes you have to explain back to him/her what he/she has said. So you should:

- interrupt regularly to ask questions (see section A)
- summarize at regular intervals (see section B)

D Discuss how successful you were as Student B in the last activity.

